João Pais Alves

Lisboa, Portugal | joaopaisalves04@gmail.com
+351 968 178 830 | linkedin.com/in/joaopaisalves

Profile

Chemical Engineer with experience in cross-functional coordination, production data analysis, and structured problem-solving in a regulated pharmaceutical environment. Certified in Project Management (Google) and experienced in aligning priorities across operations, engineering, and quality teams. Completed an AI programme at NOVA University covering Python, machine learning, and computer vision. Actively contributed to the development of an AI-powered knowledge tool using Microsoft Copilot. Comfortable working in fast-paced environments with shifting priorities and competing stakeholder needs.

Skills

Project Management: Cross-functional coordination, stakeholder alignment, project tracking, Agile methodology, process documentation, execution planning

Data & Analytics: Process data analysis, KPI monitoring, trend and deviation analysis, statistical methods, data-driven reporting

AI & Generative AI: Python (Pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, Matplotlib), ML fundamentals, computer vision, Microsoft Copilot, ChatGPT, Claude

Tools: SAP, Power BI, MATLAB, MS Office (Excel, PowerPoint), Asana

Professional Experience

Associate Process Engineer — Lisbon, Portugal
Hovione — Mar. 2025 – Present

- Coordinate across operations, engineering, and QC teams to align priorities and keep cross-functional initiatives on track
- Curate and structure process documentation for a Microsoft Copilot-based Agent, improving knowledge access across engineering teams
- Analyze production data to identify deviations and trends, translating findings into clear reports for technical stakeholders
- Support root cause analysis, synthesizing inputs from multiple teams into actionable execution plans
- Use SAP to track execution readiness and manage batch materials, contributing to 85% backlog accuracy at area level
- Prepare and review GMP documentation including batch records and cleaning procedures within regulatory compliance frameworks

Process Engineer Intern — Figueira da Foz, Portugal
Celbi, S.A. — Feb. 2024 – Feb. 2025

- Developed a MATLAB process model to analyze sensitivity and evaluate economic impact (Master's thesis)
- Calculated and analyzed hydraulic balances to support process evaluation and identify improvement opportunities

Projects

Book Spine Detection and OCR System — Capstone Project
Samsung Innovation Campus AI Course — Nov. 2025 – Feb. 2026

- Built an end-to-end computer vision pipeline in Python for book spine detection and title extraction, managing the full project lifecycle
- Applied structured workflow: data collection, labeling, model training, and performance tracking with precision/recall metrics

Education

Master's Degree in Chemical Engineering — Sept. 2022 – Sept. 2024
University of Coimbra

Bachelor's Degree in Chemical Engineering — Sept. 2019 – Jun. 2022
University of Coimbra

Certifications & Training

Samsung Innovation Campus – AI Course | NOVA University — Nov. 2025 – Feb. 2026
Python, ML (supervised/unsupervised learning), deep learning, computer vision, NLP

Google Project Management Professional Certificate — Completed: Jan. 2025

Languages

Portuguese: Native | **English:** Professional Proficiency | **Spanish:** Beginner